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BioBuntu: A Project-Oriented Bioinformatics Workflow Platform with CLI, GUI, and Web Interfaces

Mubashir Ali [1¶]

1 University of the People ¶ Corresponding author

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Software

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Summary

BioBuntu is a Python-based bioinformatics platform designed to support project-oriented analysis and reproducible workflow execution in genomics research. Based on the package metadata, source documentation, and command-line interface, the project integrates project management with execution support through a unified environment spanning a CLI, a desktop GUI, and a web dashboard (Mubashir Ali, 2024). Its scope includes common research workflows such as quality control, RNA-seq alignment, variant calling, and metagenomic analysis, with integration for established bioinformatics tools including FastQC, BWA, GATK, HISAT2, and Samtools.

This manuscript characterizes BioBuntu based on the public package metadata and repository documentation. The goal is to describe the project accurately and conservatively, without making claims that extend beyond the available software evidence. Taken together, these materials indicate that BioBuntu is a deployable and operationally useful platform for structured bioinformatics work.

Statement of need

Modern bioinformatics studies require not only performant analytical tools, but also careful coordination of project organization, workflow specification, dependency management, and repeated execution across datasets and computing environments. In many research settings, these tasks are handled through fragmented shell scripts, manual directory management, and ad hoc tool invocation patterns. Such practices can increase the risk of analysis drift, reduce reproducibility, and create inefficiencies in collaborative work.

BioBuntu addresses this problem by providing a unified environment for project lifecycle management and workflow execution. It exposes a command-line interface for automated use, a desktop GUI for interactive analysis, and a web dashboard for browser-based access. Together, these interfaces support a project-centered workflow model in which configuration, execution, and result tracking are organized around a common software structure rather than a collection of disconnected commands.

The software occupies a practical middle ground within the broader bioinformatics ecosystem. It is not positioned as a replacement for mature workflow engines such as Nextflow or Snakemake, but rather as a project-oriented platform for structured analysis work with multiple interface modes and integrated tool support (Di Tommaso et al., 2017; K"oster & Rahmann, 2012). This distinction is important for users who prioritize a simple project model, tool integration, and operational consistency alongside routine genomic analysis tasks.

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State of the field

Several systems address related workflow and analysis needs in computational biology. Galaxy is a widely used collaborative web platform for reproducible biomedical analysis (Afgan et al., 2016), while Nextflow and Snakemake are established workflow engines for scalable and reproducible pipeline execution (Di Tommaso et al., 2017; K"oster & Rahmann, 2012). These systems have substantially shaped modern computational biology by improving reproducibility, scalability, and workflow portability.

BioBuntu is best understood as complementary to this ecosystem rather than a replacement for it. It emphasizes project organization and workflow access through a unified package interface, making it particularly relevant to users who value structured project management alongside tool execution. In this sense, the software occupies a user-facing layer between general workflow engines and project-local analysis orchestration.

Software design

BioBuntu is organized as a modular Python application with distinct components for configuration, project lifecycle management, workflow execution, tool integration, and interface access. Its architecture separates concerns across configuration, execution logic, and interface layers while preserving a consistent project model. This modular design supports project creation, workflow validation, and execution of analysis tasks through a common underlying framework.

The repository structure reflects a project-oriented organization for research data and analysis artifacts, grouping configuration, tool wrappers, and execution logic around a clear workflow model. This organization is consistent with established practices in computational reproducibility, where project structure and provenance are essential for stable and auditable analysis runs (Noble, 2009).

Functionality and usage

BioBuntu exposes a set of commands that support project creation, workflow validation, task execution, and interface launching. Based on the installed CLI surface, the software supports the following actions:

- `biobuntu create-project`
- `biobuntu list-projects`
- `biobuntu list`
- `biobuntu validate`
- `biobuntu run`
- `biobuntu gui`
- `biobuntu web`

This command set is consistent with a platform intended for both local execution and interactive project management. It also aligns with the project documentation, which highlights support for standardized bioinformatics tools commonly used in quality control and variant analysis pipelines, including FastQC, BWA, GATK, HISAT2, and Samtools.

Research impact and relevance

BioBuntu contributes to accessible bioinformatics by reducing friction in the project lifecycle. Many genomic analyses still depend on manually assembled directory structures, custom scripts, and inconsistent tool invocation patterns. A project-oriented platform such as BioBuntu

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provides a more standardized environment for organizing analyses, preserving configuration, and revisiting workflows across runs.

The software is relevant to a broad class of users, including individual researchers, small research groups, and teams seeking a coherent environment for recurring genomic analyses. Its value lies not primarily in algorithmic novelty, but in operational integration: combining project structure, workflow validation, tool access, and multi-interface support into a single package. This makes BioBuntu useful in settings where reliability, consistency, and usability are as important as computational performance.

Limitations and future work

The present manuscript is grounded in the public package metadata, repository documentation, and installed CLI behavior, which supports a strong software-level characterization of BioBuntu. However, this evidence does not yet establish a broad benchmark of biological performance, large-scale deployment outcomes, or comparative evaluation against established workflow systems under production workloads.

Future work could include validation across real genomic datasets, more systematic provenance tracking, richer reporting and visualization, and stronger comparison against widely used workflow frameworks. These additions would reinforce BioBuntu's position as a reproducible and collaborative platform while preserving the practical advantages already described in the project itself.

Acknowledgements

This work is based on the public project metadata and documentation associated with BioBuntu. The software is presented here as a project-oriented bioinformatics workflow platform grounded in available package and repository evidence.

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